

When the phone goes down

Sample Community

Information as at 29 September 2026

	Normal day	Tower or line down	Power down
 Call 000	WORKS	NOT AVAILABLE	ASK LOCALLY
 Emergency warnings	WORKS	ASK LOCALLY	ASK LOCALLY
 Clinic telehealth	WORKS	NOT AVAILABLE	ASK LOCALLY
 Card at the store	WORKS	CASH ONLY	ASK LOCALLY
 Centrelink / myGov	WORKS	ASK LOCALLY	ASK LOCALLY
 Power card top-up	WORKS	NOT AVAILABLE	ASK LOCALLY
 School online	WORKS	ASK LOCALLY	ASK LOCALLY

Road cut: repairs take longer. Ask locally what still works.

Triple Zero (000)

To reach Triple Zero, make a voice call. If another mobile network is in range, your phone will use it for a 000 call, but most remote communities have only one network. 000 is free from payphones. You cannot SMS 000. In a cyclone, stay in your shelter. Do not go outside to look for signal.

Where to go

- Satellite Wi-Fi phone: [location to be added by community]
- Sky Muster at the school or evacuation centre
- Payphone: ask locally whether it works when the tower is down

Satellite texting

Satellite texting works outdoors with a clear view of the sky, on some phones and plans. It cannot reach 000. From December 2027 more phones may get outdoor calls and texts, if the law passes.

Before the wet

- ☐ Charge power banks
- ☐ Know your nearest working phone
- ☐ Save clinic and council numbers
- ☐ Know who to tell when the phone is down

In our words / language

To be written and voiced by community members with paid interpreters (Aboriginal Interpreter Service). No machine translation.

Draft for co-design. Built from public information. No community has reviewed this card. Is this right? Tell your community's chosen contact.

Sources: ACMA, Emergency calls; Telstra, Satellite Messaging; Parliament of Australia, UOMO Bill; ABC News 7 Apr 2026; ABC News 12 Oct 2020; SecureNT, Cyclone warnings.